

Tending the Healer

A RETREAT FOR HEALTHCARE PROFESSIONALS

Healthcare professionals witness loss, suffering, and profound moments of humanity every day. While we are often called to care for others, we rarely have dedicated space to care for the grief we carry ourselves.

This restorative retreat invites healthcare professionals to slow down, reconnect with themselves, and gently tend to grief related to patient loss, cumulative caregiving, moral distress, personal loss, and the many invisible burdens carried in this work.

Together, we will explore self-compassion, reflection, meaningful ritual, community, and Indigenous teachings rooted in the Medicine Wheel. Participants will be invited to honor their experiences, reconnect with inner resilience, and develop practices to support well-being in both personal and professional lives.

Held at the House of Welcome Longhouse at The Evergreen State College in Olympia, this retreat welcomes healthcare professionals from all disciplines and backgrounds. No prior experience with Indigenous teachings or mindfulness practices is needed - only a willingness to come as you are.



Retreat Details



Saturday,
October 10th, 2026



9:30am - 4:00pm



House of Welcome Longhouse,
Evergreen State College,
Olympia, WA



Cost per person: \$195
(discount available for
enrolled tribal members)



Beverages & light refreshments
provided. Bring lunch or
purchase at Evergreen dining.

FACILITATORS



Akasha Balkman, LICSW

Licensed Clinical Social Worker, Pediatric Palliative Care Specialist at Seattle Children's Hospital, founder of Sweetgrass & Sage Counseling, and co-founder of Hello Angel. As an enrolled member of the Yankton Sioux Tribe, she integrates Indigenous teachings, traditional practices, and the Medicine Wheel framework into her work.



Kari Hilwig, LICSW

Licensed Clinical Social Worker and psychotherapist specializing in serious and chronic illness, grief and loss, and supporting caregivers. Her background in palliative care and oncology social work informs her relational, existential, and strengths-based approach.



Register by
SEPTEMBER 25TH, 2026

Register online:

tinyurl.com/tend-healer

Scan the QR code to register

